Academic Editing | Portfolio Case Study

Ongoing collaboration · Three-paper PhD thesis · Planned completion: November 2026 · APA 7

The project and client

This sample is a small extract from a PhD thesis comprising three research papers. I have worked with the author on this long-term editing project for more than four years, and the collaboration is ongoing, with completion planned for November 2026. The client is a Russian first-language doctoral researcher writing in English as an additional language (approximately B2 level). The thesis examines corporate governance and boards in Russian firms and is intended for an international academic examination panel. My brief is to produce doctoral-level American English while preserving the author's argument, research voice and disciplinary terminology.

My approach

I edit long or awkward sentences, clarify the sequence of ideas and apply American English conventions throughout the thesis. I preserve established research terms such as monitoring task and service task, rather than replacing them with superficially smoother alternatives. I check substantive changes with the author and query uncertain evidence rather than silently rewriting it.

Three editorial decisions

01 Quotation and attribution

Separated a quotation from the author's interpretation, removed evaluative phrasing and queried the original speaker, source and page number.

02 Terminology and clarity

Recast an unnatural description of international governance principles, shortened the argument and retained the technical terms used in board research.

03 Research gap and precision

Made the gap concerning boards in Russian mid-sized private companies explicit. Confirmed with the author that adoption of governance standards by large public companies was legally required.

Citation and editorial quality assurance

I standardise APA 7 in-text citations and check bibliographic details for discrepancies in publication years, author spellings and coauthor attribution. I treat source existence and support for a specific claim as separate checks. The quotation's origin and some claim-to-source matches remain open queries; this sample does not represent a completed reference audit.

What the accompanying document shows

The separate tracked-changes Word file contains three editing examples, showing original and revised wording as actual insertions and deletions, alongside short, direct comments to the author. It can be opened in Word or Google Docs to inspect the revisions and queries.

Scope note: Anonymised portfolio demonstration developed collaboratively from authorised thesis material. The displayed revisions were prepared for this sample and are not presented as the original client-delivered edits.